

Course Information

Course Title: General Psychology
Course Number: PSY150 Section: 0020
Classroom Date/Time: Tuesdays & Thursday| 10:00am-11:15am via Microsoft Teams
Classroom Location: N/A
Date/Time: May 18- July 13
Semester: Summer 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor: Ashley Brown
Contact Information: ambrown29@waketech.edu
Virtual Office Hours on Microsoft Teams

- Monday & Wednesday 11:30 a.m.–1:00 p.m. EST
- Teams ID: ambrown29

Required Textbook

Spielman, R. M., Jenkins, W. J., & Lovett, M. D. (2020). Psychology 2e. OpenStax.

Online Access at URL: <https://openstax.org/details/books/psychology-2e>

This textbook is direct access, published by Rice University, and **free**! Create your student account to access other resources and tools.

Instructor Policies

Attendance Policy: Wake Tech expects students to attend at least 90% of all scheduled class meetings. If a student's consecutive absences from class exceed 10% of the total instructional time, the student has not communicated with the instructor and the student is currently not passing the class, then the faculty member should withdraw the student from the class. **Students are allowed a maximum of two absences: per Wake Tech policy.**

This course will meet via Microsoft Teams on Tuesday & Thursday at 10:00am-11:15am. Students are expected to log in regularly, keep up with weekly modules, and complete assignments by the posted deadlines.

Grade Appeal Policy: If students are unable to resolve their concerns with the instructor, they may submit a [Final Course Grade Appeal Request form](#). Students must submit this form within 90 days of the last day of the course in which the grade was awarded. Final grades cannot be appealed beyond this period.

Withdrawal Policy: Withdrawal on or before **July 1** will result in a “W” on your transcript. Withdrawal after **July 1** will result in a “WF” on your transcript. A “WF” is treated as an “F” in calculating your grade point average (GPA).

Discussion of Grades Via Email : Due to the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) of 1974, instructors will not discuss any information pertaining to a student’s grade or other matters related to academic performance via email or telephone unless the student signs an Authorization to Release Instructor Graded Material via Email form (WTCC Form 1126) waiving his or her FERPA rights.

Test/Exams: Students will not be allowed to reschedule, or retake missed exams. It is essential to attend scheduled exams and adhere to the exam dates and times provided. Exceptions to this policy will only be made in cases of documented medical emergencies or other extenuating circumstances, and such cases will be reviewed individually.

Assignment Submission Policy: All students must submit their assignments as a **Word Docx or PDF file. Do not use Google Docs, Dropbox or other file sharing sites to submit work for our class.** Failure to submit the assignment in Word Doc or PDF format will result in an **automatic zero.**

Students are responsible for ensuring that all uploaded assignments are the correct file, draft, format, and version. Blackboard provides a preview option to confirm submissions, and multiple attempts are permitted for all file uploads. Submitting an incorrect, incomplete, or corrupt file may result in penalties.

Students are encouraged to submit assignments prior to the due date; however, once an assignment has been graded, **resubmissions are not permitted.** All assignments for this class are **due at 11:59pm Eastern Standard Time.** All work must be submitted on Blackboard by the stated due date/time to have the possibility of earning full credit.

Late Submission Policy: Students are not allowed to turn-in late assignments, quizzes, or exams. **All assignments and quizzes will be due every Sunday at 11:59pm.** Assignments that have been available for several weeks or months prior to the due date will receive a grade of zero if not submitted on time, regardless of the circumstances. Students are strongly encouraged to complete assignments in a timely manner and avoid waiting until the deadline to submit their work.

Communication and Interaction: I welcome and encourage regular communication and interaction throughout the course. Please adhere to netiquette and professional email norms in all our written communication.

Contact Information:

- Email: You are welcome to send me an email at ambrown29@waketech.edu for any questions, concerns, or to schedule virtual meetings.
 - **Please include your name and course section number in your email**
 - **Ex: John Doe PSY150-1234**
- Microsoft Teams: You can also reach out to me via Microsoft Teams for quick chat-based communication.

Response Time: I strive to respond to emails and messages within one business day. If you have not received a response within this time frame, please feel free to send a follow-up email or message. Clear and open lines of communication are essential for a successful learning experience, and I am here to assist you throughout the course. Please reach out if you have any questions or need support.

Preferred Pronoun Statement: Pervasive gender normatively is reflected in our use of language, and language instruction is one of the spaces in which such traditional structures are reinforced. At Wake Tech, we strive to be respectful and inclusive. While the learning outcomes for this course require us to use language in its normative form, I encourage you to be aware of the implications of such norms and to be respectful of your classmates' and instructors' requests. Please contact me right away should you have any preferred name and/or preferred pronoun by which you would like to be addressed. Although there are limitations to what the language allows grammatically, I will try to find an appropriate solution.

Safe Spaces Statement: Wake Tech is proud to have numerous faculty and staff on various campuses who have pledged to create safe spaces in support of LGBTQIA students and their allies. A list of supporter names and their office locations is accessible at Wake Tech Full Spectrum Allies on Campus (opens in a new window). Plain text link: [Full Spectrum GSA](#).

Preferred Name Statement: All students can provide Blackboard Learn with their preferred name by following the directions provided on Blackboard Help. Guidance is available at Blackboard Help for Personal Settings (opens in a new window), located at [Student Personal Setting](#). Please email Holly Swart at heswart@waketech.edu (opens in new window). Plain text link: heswart@waketech.edu, directly to ensure that your preferred name is on file with the Registration and Records Registrar as Wake Tech may need to confirm that your information is the same everywhere.

Students Facing Difficulty Outside of School Statement: Any student who faces challenges securing their food or housing and believes this may affect their performance in this course is urged to notify me if you are comfortable in doing so. Similarly, if you are experiencing any physical or mental health challenges that may impede your ability to be successful in your learning, I encourage you to reach out to the campus resources that may be most helpful to you. Appointments can be made with a Wake Tech counselor on campus by accessing Wake Tech Wellness Services (opens in a new window), Plain text link: [Wellness Services](#).

Course Outline

Discussion Board (20%)

The discussion board is an essential part of our online learning community. It provides a space for you to interact with classmates, share insights, apply psychological concepts, and think critically about the material we cover each week. Participation in discussions will help deepen your understanding of the course content while also building communication skills and encouraging diverse perspectives.

- Post an original response to the discussion question(s) **by Thursday at 11:59pm.**
- **Posts should contain a minimum of 175 words to receive full credit.** Your response should demonstrate critical thinking, use course concepts, and provide examples or evidence when appropriate.
- Reply to at **least two classmates'** posts to extend the conversation.
 - **Responses to classmates should be posted by Sunday at 11:59pm**
- **Responses should contain a minimum of 65 words** to receive full credit. Thoughtful replies may include ask follow-up questions, offering different perspectives, or connecting ideas to real-world examples

Assignments (25%)

Throughout this semester, we will engage in a variety of online activities and assignments designed to enhance academic success, strengthen critical thinking skills, and deepen our exploration of the mind and behavior in psychology. These activities are intended to be engaging, interactive, and at times collaborative, creating a dynamic online learning environment.

- **Students who do not complete online activities by the deadline will receive a score of zero**, and no makeup opportunities will be provided. It is your responsibility to remain actively engaged and to submit work on time.
- **All assignments will be due every Sunday at 11:59pm. All students are required to submit their assignments as a Word Docx or PDF file.**

Weekly Quizzes (25%)

Throughout the semester, you will complete chapter quizzes on Blackboard to demonstrate your understanding of the assigned readings and course content.

- **Quiz Details:**
 - Quizzes will consist of multiple-choice questions based on the chapter material.
 - Each quiz will include no more than 15 questions.
 - **Quizzes must be completed in a single sitting**; progress cannot be saved and resumed later. You will have **30 minutes** to complete each quiz once it is started.
- **Quiz Schedule:**
 - Chapter quizzes will be posted every Monday on Blackboard, aligned with the week's assigned readings.
 - All quizzes are due by **Sunday at 11:59 PM (EST)**.
 - **Late submissions will not be accepted under any circumstances.**

Midterm Exam (15%)

These exams are designed to comprehensively assess your understanding of the course material. Please manage your time carefully to complete each exam within the specified time frame.

- **Exam Details:**
 - The midterm exam will be administered online
 - This will be listed as Exam 1 on the Exam Calendar below

Final Exam (15%)

These exams are designed to comprehensively assess your understanding of the course material. Please manage your time carefully to complete each exam within the specified time frame.

- **Exam Details:**
 - The final exam will be administered online
 - This will be listed as Exam 2 on the Exam Calendar below

Exam Calendar
Please review the exam schedule and chapter coverage carefully. Each exam will assess your understanding of the chapters listed below.

Exam	Topics
1	Ch01: Introduction to Psychology
1	Ch02: Psychological Research Methods
1	Ch03: Biopsychology
1	Ch05: Sensation and Perception
1	Ch06: Learning
1	Ch07: Thinking and Intelligence
1	Ch08: Memory
2	Ch09: Lifespan Development
2	Ch10: Emotions and Motivation
2	Ch11: Personality
2	Ch12: Social Psychology
2	Ch14: Stress, Lifestyle, and Health
2	Ch15: Psychological Disorders
2	Ch16: Therapy and Treatment

Grading Scale

Your final course grade is a calculated, weighted average, using the category weights described above, based on Wake Tech's standard 10-point scale.

Grades:

- A = 90 and above
- B = 80 and above
- C = 70 and above
- D = 60 and above
- F = below 60.
- Grades are not rounded (e.g., 89.9 is a B, 90 is an A)

Important Dates

First day of class: May 18

Last day to drop with 100% refund: May 17

Last day to add: May 19

Last day to drop with 75% refund: May 20

No classes May 25, July 3

Last day to withdraw with W: July 1

Session ends: July 13

****At the conclusion of the semester, the lowest quiz/assignment grade will be dropped from the final grade calculation. This policy is intended to provide students with some flexibility in the event of an unexpected difficulty (e.g., illness, technical issue, or scheduling conflict). Please note that only one grade will be dropped, and all remaining quizzes/assignments will count toward the final course grade.**

All Assignments and Quizzes are due at 11:59pm on Sunday		
Date	Topics	Assignments
Week 1: May18 – May 24	Ch01-Introduction of Psychology Ch02- Psychological Research Methods	Weekly Assignment Weekly Quiz on Ch 1 & 2 Course Entry Quiz
Week 2: May 25– May 31	Ch03-Biopsychology Ch04-Sensation and Perception	Discussion Board Weekly Quiz on Ch 3 & Ch 4
Week 3: Jun 1- Jun 7	Ch06- Learning Ch07- Thinking and Intelligence	Weekly Assignment Weekly Quiz on Ch 6 & Ch 7 Discussion Board
Week 4: Jun 8- Jun 14	Ch08- Memory	Weekly Assignment Midterm Exam: June 11-June 14
Week 5: Jun 15-June 21	Ch09- Emotion and Motivation Ch10- Lifespan Development	Weekly Quiz on Ch 9 & Ch 10 Discussion Board
Week 6: Jun 22- Jun 28	Ch11- Personality Ch12- Social Psychology	Weekly Assignment Weekly Quiz on Ch 11 & Ch 12 Discussion Board
Week 7: June 29- July 5	Ch13- Stress, Lifestyle, and Health Ch14-Psychological Disorders	Weekly Assignment Weekly Quiz on Ch 13 & Ch 14
Week 8: July 6- July 13	Ch15- Therapy and Treatment	Weekly Quiz on Ch 15 Discussion Board
Final Exam Date: July 9- July 12		